feeding is essential. Fruits and vegetables can be given, fat rich foods, fried foods, exercise seasoning, coffee in large amounts and stronger flavoured vegetables may be restricted or eliminated if the nausea persists.

b) Heart burn

Increase progesterone production, cost decreased tone and mobility of the smooth muscles of gastrointestinal tract. This leads to regurgitation. Heartburn is a common complaint during the later part of pregnancy. This is usually, can be relieved by small and frequent meals limiting the amount of food consumed at one time and drinking fluids between meals. Sitting upright after meals at least for 3 hours before lying down may also help.

c) Constipation

The pressure of the enlarging uterus on the lower portion of the intestine, in addition to the hormonal muscle relaxant effect of placental hormones on the gastrointestinal tract may result in constipation. Increased the fluid intake and use of natural laxative foods such as whole grains, dried fruits and other fruits, vegetables that are rich in fibre, juices usually induce regularity.

d) Oedema

Mild, physiologic oedema is usually present in the extremities in the third trimester. Swelling of lower extremities may be caused by the pressure of the enlarging uterus on the veins returning fluid from the legs. The normal oedema requires no sodium restriction or other dietary changes.

e) Pica

Consumption of non - food items like laundry starch, ice cubes or clay is called pica. It occurs more often during pregnancy than at any other time. A deficiency for essential nutrient, such as calcium or iron, results in the eating of non - food substances that contain these nutrients

Activity : 2

Suggest some fibre rich diets to avoid constipation during pregnancy.

2.1.7 Practices incompatible with pregnancy

Besides malnutrition, a variety of lifestyle factors can have adverse effects on pregnancy and some may teratogenic. People who are planning to have a children can make the choice to practice healthy behaviours.

a) Alcohol

Alcohol consumption during pregnancy can cause irreversible mental and physical retardation of the foetus. Foetal alcohol syndrome (FAS) of the leading causes of mental retardation is the only one that is totally preventable.

b) Medicinal drugs

Drugs other than alcohol can also cause complication during pregnancy, problems in labour, and serious birth defects. For this reason pregnant women should not take any medicines without consulting their physician.

c) Illicit drugs

The recommendation to avoid a drugs during pregnancy also includes illicit drugs, of course. Unfortunately, use of illicit drugs such as cocaine and marijuna, is common among some pregnant women. Drug of abuse, such as cocaine, easily cross the placenta and impact foetal development further more they are responsible for preterm birth, low birth weight infant, perinatal death, and sudden infant death. If these new-born's survive their crisis and behaviour at birth are abnormal, and their cognitive development later in life is impaired.

d) Smoking and chewing tobacco

Smoking cigarettes and chewing tobacco at any time exert harmful effects, and pregnancy dramatically magnifies the hazards of these

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